

» SPORTSTAR ACES INTERVIEW — CHANDU BORDE

For old time's sake: Former Indian cricketer Chandu Borde donned multiple hats after retiring from the game.

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'WE NEVER PLAYED FOR MONEY'

Chandu Borde was recently honoured with the **Lifetime Achievement Award** at the Sportstar Aces Awards function in Mumbai. In an engaging chat, he shares some memorable experiences from on and off the field.

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Chandrakant Gulabrao, known as Chandu Borde, a versatile cricketer who played 52 Tests for India in the 1950s and 1960s, is set to celebrate his 90th birthday in July. After retiring from the game, Borde remained actively involved in Indian cricket, serving as a selector, team manager (de facto coach), and cricket manager until 2007. Recently, he was honoured with the *IDFC First Bank Lifetime*

Achievement Award at the Sportstar Aces Awards 2024. Before graciously accepting the award and captivating the audience with his witty humour, Borde reflected on his cricket journey, sharing some memorable experiences from his time on and off the field.

Reflecting on nearly eight decades of your association with cricket, how do you perceive the journey you've undertaken thus far?

I have never thought about this. I have spent so much time with the game. I never felt like I was such an old man or something. Sometimes, when I sit back and think about the people with whom I played and the people with whom I was associated, I feel very, very happy. To know them, the wonderful time I had during my cricketing period, the ups and downs... I wonder about present-day cricket because there is so much change in the game — in bowling, batting, fielding, everything. I don't